

LEARNERS BOOK ONE

Chapter 7 - BASIC SKILLS IN ROUNDERS.

Define in details what rounders game is in PE, Equipment for rounders and play area, Basic skills used in rounders, Positional play in rounders, safety precautions to consider in playing rounders, rules of rounders as a game.

Introduction

Rounders is a bat-and-ball game popular in British and Irish schools, similar to baseball and softball. Played in PE (Physical Education) classes, it's a team sport that encourages running, hand-eye coordination, teamwork, and strategic thinking. Here's a detailed breakdown of its components:

1. Overview of Rounders in PE

Rounders is played by two teams, where one team bats, and the other fields. The goal of the batting team is to score "rounders" by hitting a pitched ball and running around four bases arranged in a diamond. The fielding team tries to get the batters out by catching the ball after it is hit or by throwing it to base players to tag out runners.

2. Equipment for Rounders and Play Area

- **Bat:** A rounders bat is a short, smooth wooden or metal bat about 18 inches long and with a maximum diameter of 2 inches. It's designed to be gripped easily with one hand.
 - **Ball:** The ball used in rounders is hard, similar in size to a baseball, with a circumference of about 7.5 inches.
 - **Posts/Bases:** The bases, typically four, are set up in a diamond shape on a grass or outdoor playing field. The posts are usually 4 feet tall, marked by a small circle or rubber mat.
 - **Playing Area:** The playing field is roughly 50 meters in diameter with bases approximately 12 meters apart.
-

3. Basic Skills in Rounders

- **Batting:** Players must develop hand-eye coordination and timing to make effective contact with the ball. Proper stance and grip are crucial.
- **Catching:** Fielders need to catch the ball quickly and securely to prevent runs and execute outs.

- **Throwing:** Accurate and strong throwing is vital for fielders to get the ball quickly to other bases or back to the bowler.
 - **Running:** Speed and agility are key for batters to make it around the bases before being tagged out by fielders.
 - **Fielding:** Awareness, positioning, and teamwork help fielders cover the field effectively and stop the opposing team from scoring.
-

4. Positional Play in Rounders

- **Bowler:** Similar to a pitcher, the bowler throws the ball underarm to the batter.
 - **Backstop:** Positioned behind the batter, they catch balls missed by the batter, ready to throw to other fielders.
 - **Base Fielders:** Positioned at the first, second, third, and fourth bases, responsible for tagging out runners who try to reach their bases.
 - **Deep Fielders:** Positioned away from the bases, they retrieve balls hit further afield and quickly return them to the bases to prevent scoring.
-

5. Safety Precautions in Playing Rounders

- **Protective Equipment:** Helmets and gloves can be worn, especially for younger players, to prevent injuries.
 - **Spacing and Positioning:** Players must stay clear of the swinging bat and be aware of the ball in play.
 - **Warm-Up:** A thorough warm-up and stretching routine help prevent strains and muscle injuries.
 - **Supervision:** An adult or PE teacher should supervise, ensuring fair play and quick responses to injuries.
 - **Weather Conditions:** Play should be stopped in adverse weather, especially on wet or muddy fields to prevent slips and falls.
-

6. Rules of Rounders

- **Gameplay:** Each team has an inning to bat and field. An inning consists of all players from one team having a chance to bat.
- **Scoring:** A "rounder" is scored when a batter hits the ball and successfully runs around all four bases. Half a rounder can be scored if a batter reaches the fourth base without hitting the ball.
- **Outs:** A batter is out if the ball is caught on the full, if they are tagged or stumped at a base, or if they miss two consecutive balls from the bowler.
- **Bowling:** The bowler must deliver underarm and within reach of the batter, with no more than one bounce before the batter.
- **No Balls:** If the bowler throws a ball that is too high, too low, or out of the batter's reach, it is considered a "no-ball," allowing the batter to let it pass without penalty.

- **Running Rules:** Batters must run in a clockwise direction around the bases. They cannot run backwards and must touch each base they pass.
-

Rounders promotes both physical activity and strategic teamwork skills, making it a beneficial game for PE.

Compiled By,

Kirabo Peter Fredrick

HOD – PHYSICAL EDUCATION